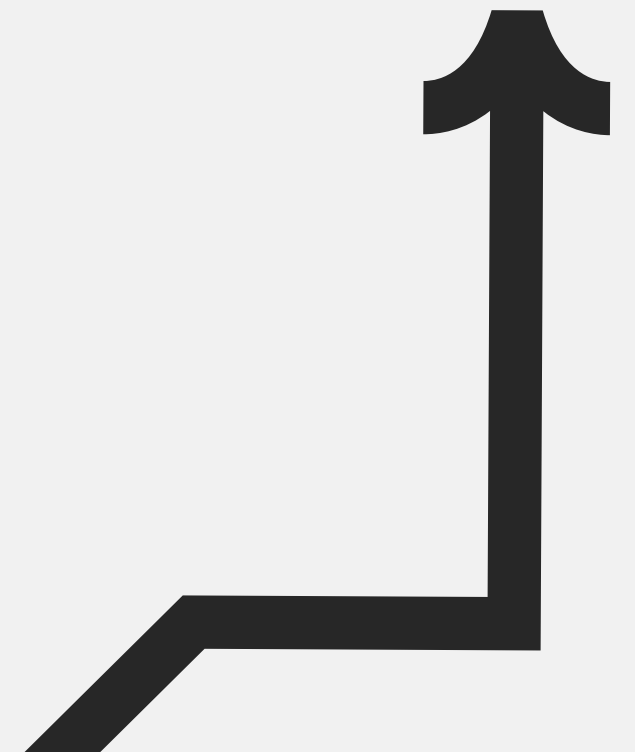


The U.S Housing Crisis: Ending Single-Family Zoning

PRESENTED BY

Ingrid Yang



Imagine being unable to find or afford housing due to:

- Income
- Renter status
- Skin color

... this is the reality many face

In the future:

Most of us will move out of home & start families, work new jobs, etc., & must search for a new home.



Major Crisis In U.S Housing Market

- Worsened by restrictive zoning practices
- Continues to negatively impact communities across the country

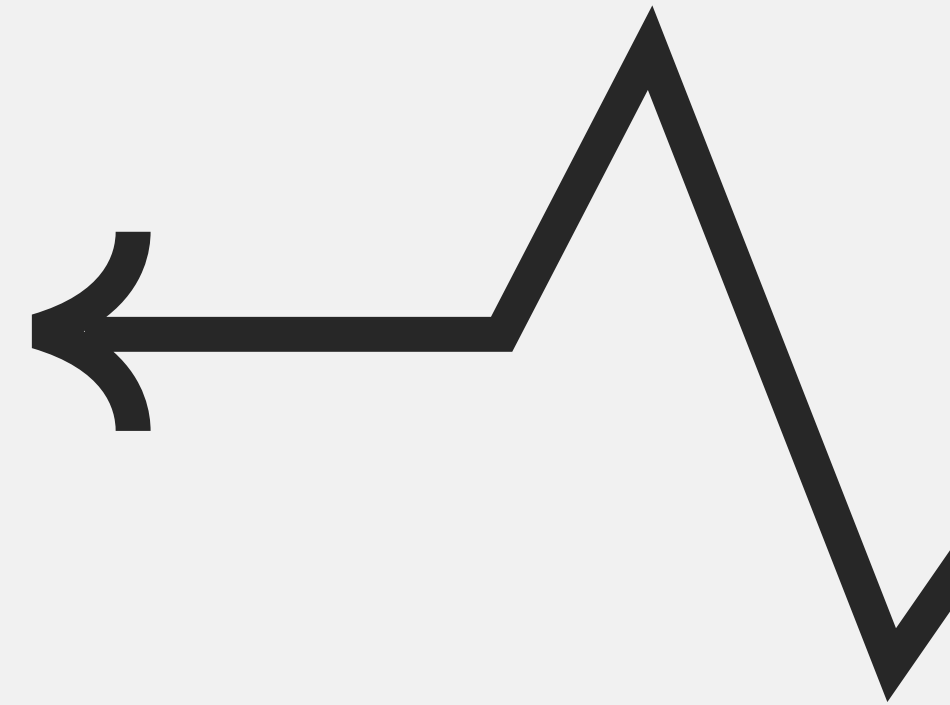
Introduction

Thesis



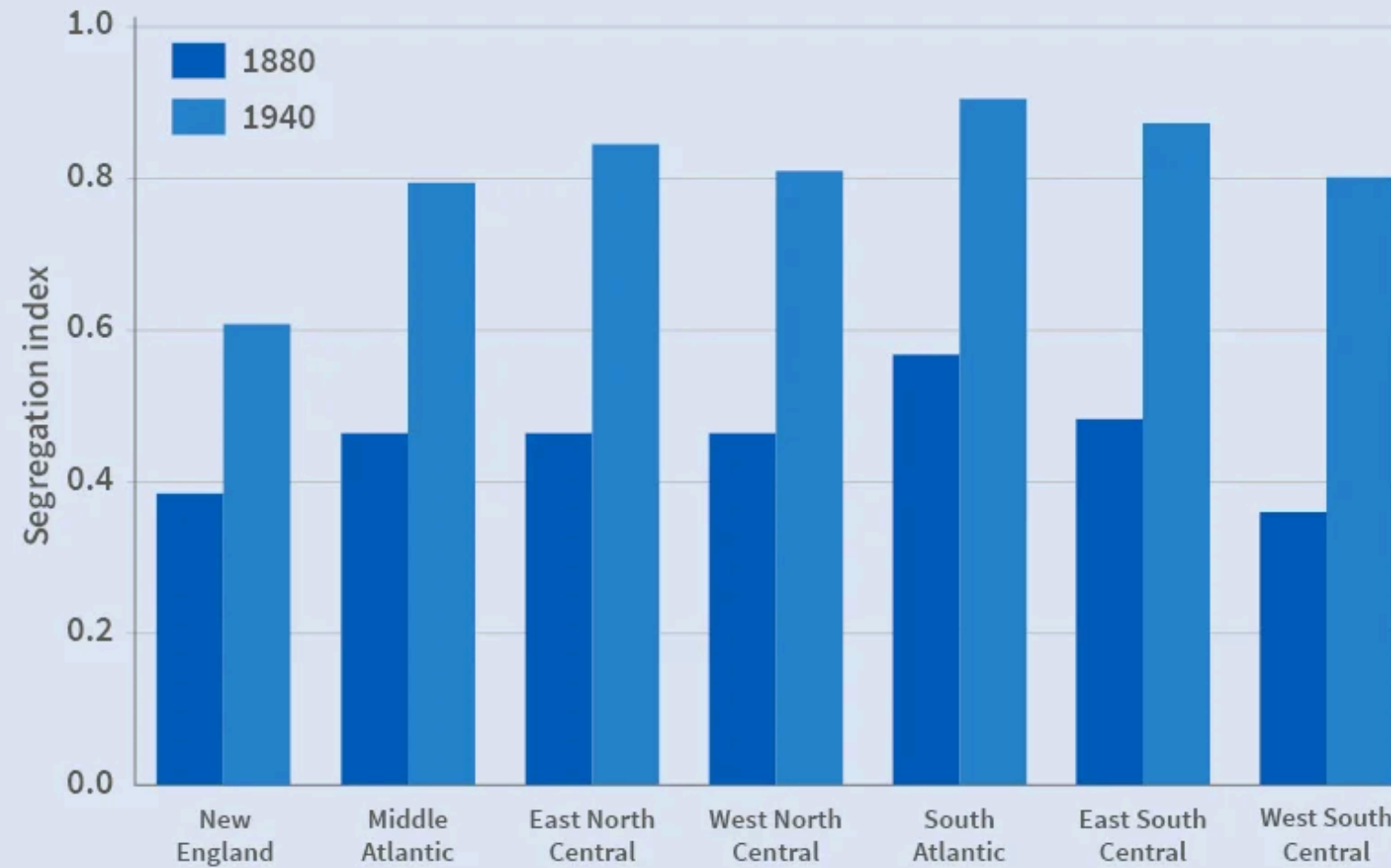
Our local, state, and federal governments must take active steps in solving the problems crippling the country's current housing situation

- Reverse the damage caused in the past
- Make it easier for individuals & families to attain affordable housing



Problem: Single-Family Zoning

SEGREGATION DOUBLED BETWEEN 1880 AND 1940



Source: Bureau of the Census



What it is: A zoning policy that restricts development in an area to single-family homes (Planetizen)

**Why We
Must
Address:**

- Racial & class discrimination/segregation
- Promotes exclusion
- Growing scarcity of homes
- Unreasonable prices

Significance:

*Inequitable,
inefficient, &
unsustainable*



- ➔ “Single most harmful widely used practice in planning” (Wegmann, 2019)
- ➔ “Responsible for racial segregation, disparities in public goods provision, growing regional inequality, & exploding housing costs” (Shertzer, 2021)
- ➔ “Single-family suburbs produce higher greenhouse gas emissions per person than cities” (Hanley, 2023)

Solution

*“Merely eliminating single-family zoning is unlikely to increase housing stock significantly”
(Hoffman, 2021)*

Bundled Reform

- Minimize floor area & lot size requirements
- More ACUs & SROs
- More affordable housing near transit
- More programs helping low-income families secure housing



- Find the “Missing Middle:” gap between two extremes
- Reduces living costs
- Less CO2 emissions

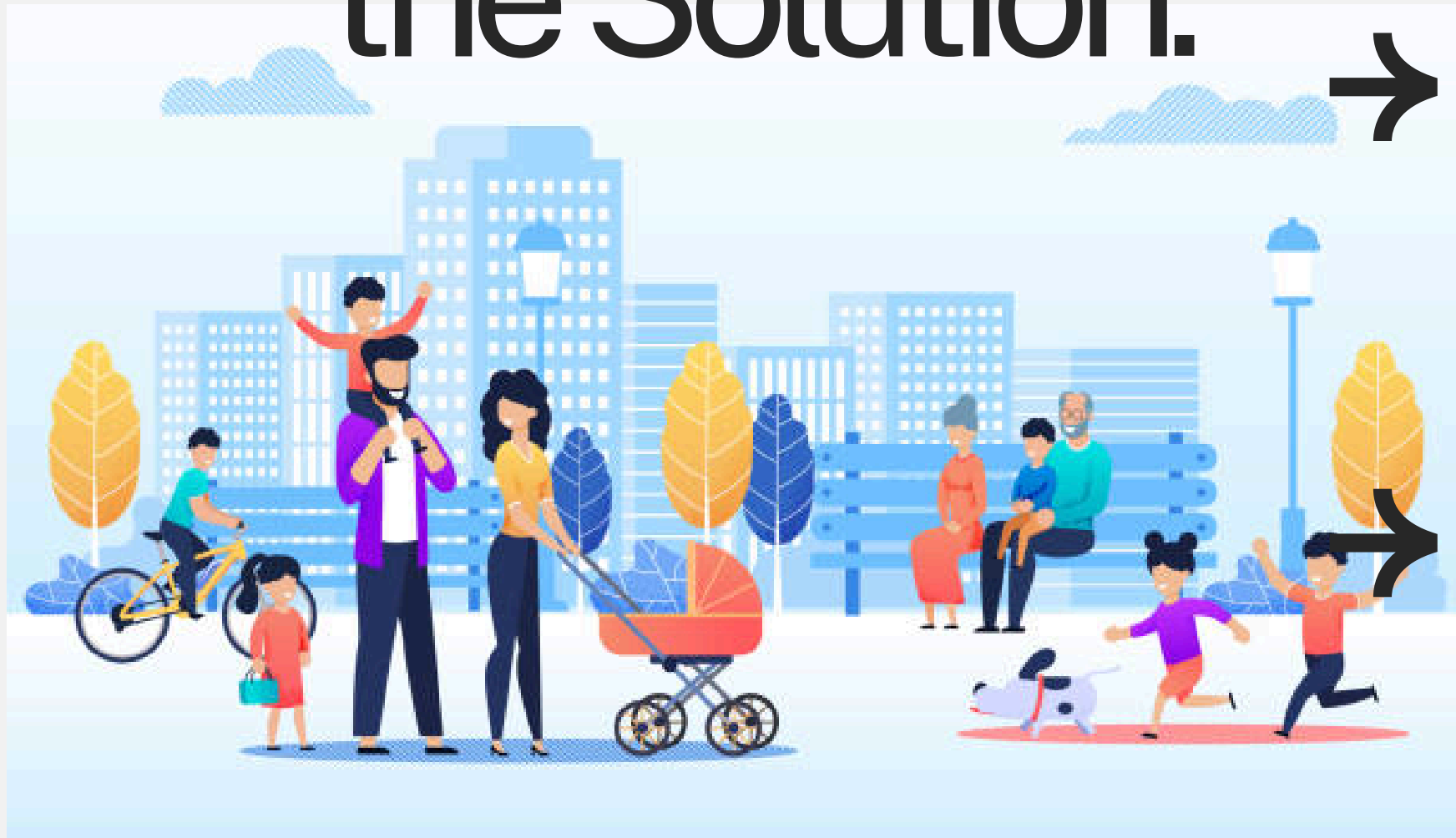


How It Solves the Problem

- Efficient land use, sustainable growth, less urban sprawl
 - Neighborhood revitalization



Benefits of the Solution:



Remove barriers faced by marginalized & under-resourced communities



Lowered living costs, greater access to opportunities, better quality of life



Improve public health, the environment, promote socio-economic justice

A World of Change

Cities & Communities: *More connected,
more equitable, more inclusive*

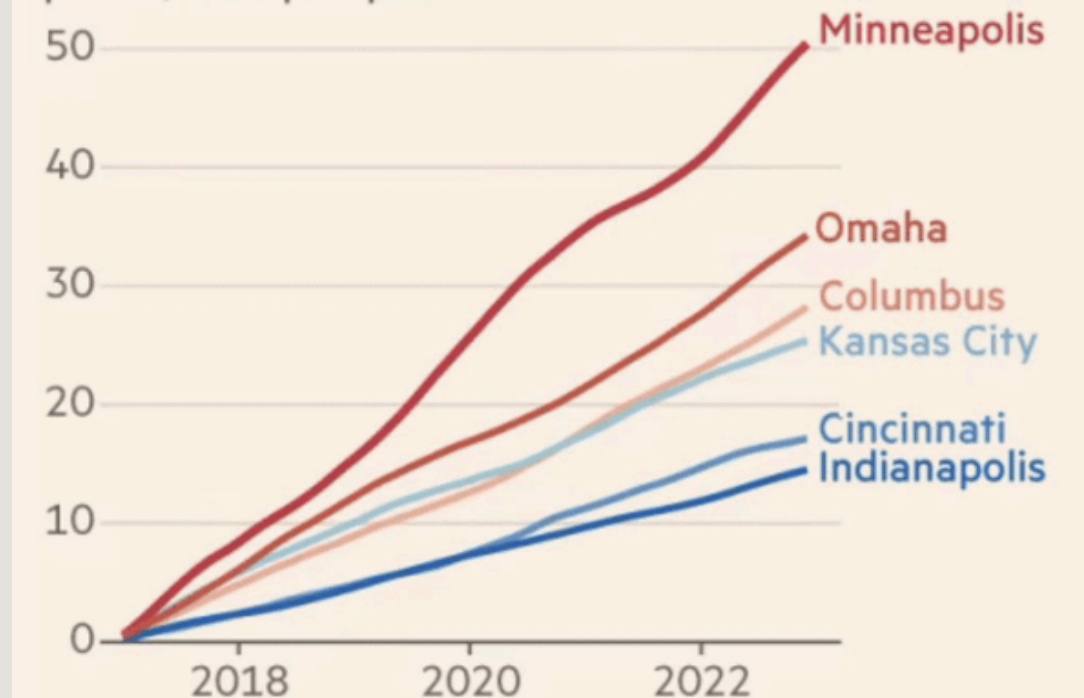
EX: Minneapolis

A Society Led By:

- Opportunity
- Fairness
- Compassion

Minneapolis has built more housing
than other Midwestern cities...

Cumulative new dwelling approvals
per 1,000 people

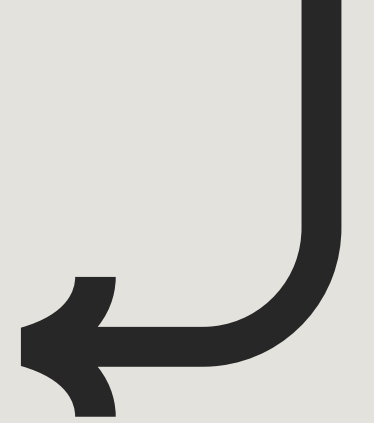


...and is reaping the rewards as rents
fall relative to inflation

Real-terms change in median rent
(Jan 2017 = 100)

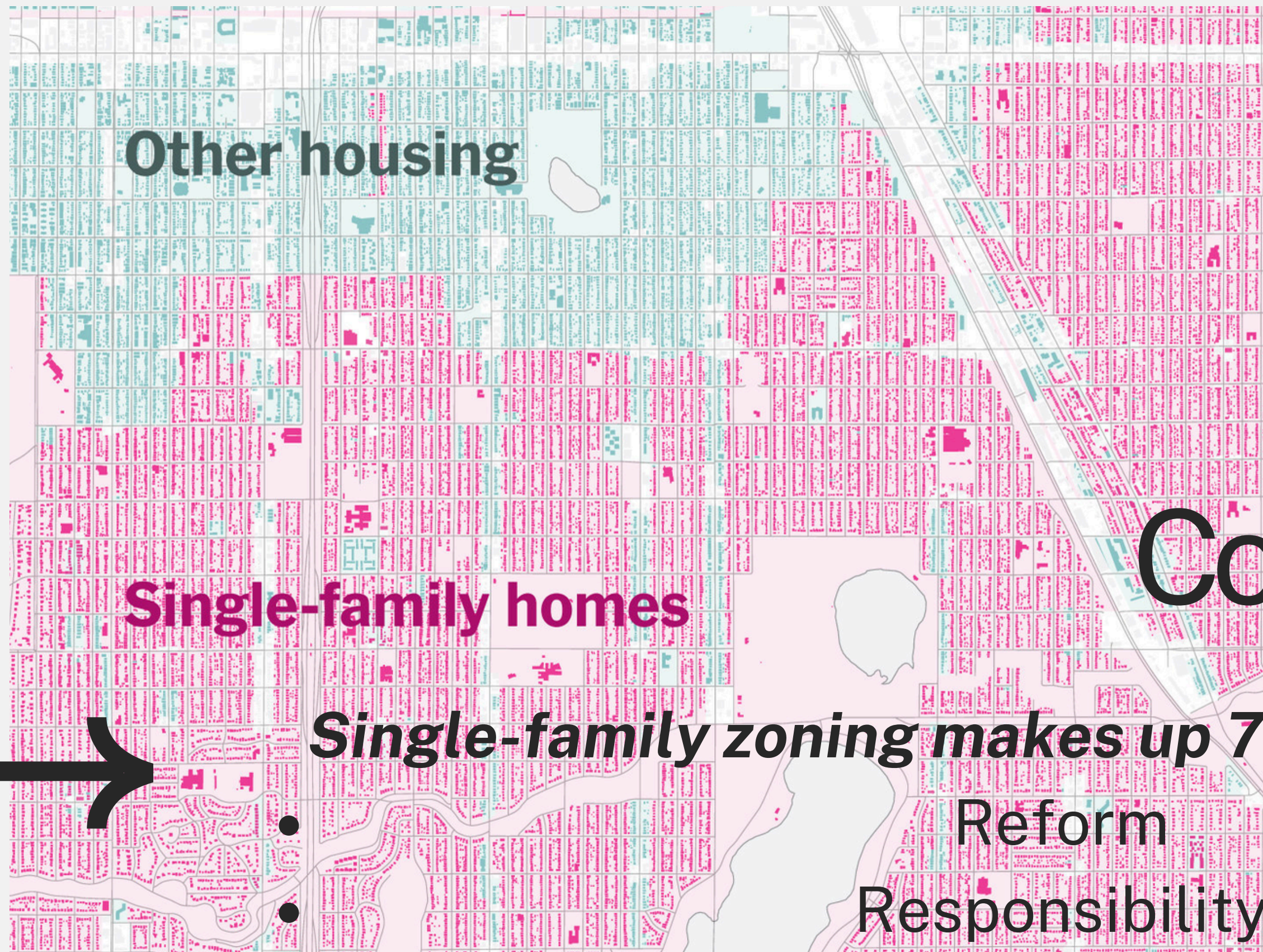


Call To Action



Education, Advocacy, Civic Engagement, Investment

What You Can Do	How You Can Do It	Programs & Orgs
• Understand & help others understand • Via government: advocate for better policies • Support orgs & investors who share our mission	• Contact elected officials & share concerns • Participate in local gov. meetings: vocalize your opinion • Join coalitions • Donate	• Housing Voucher Program • Low-Income Housing Tax Credit • Maryland Affordable Housing Coalition • Mercy Housing Inc.



Conclusion

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